Chapter 1 Exercise: Introduction to Communication and Communication in the Workplace

Multiple Choice

1. In the six-phase communication process, what happens immediately after the sender encodes the idea?

a) The receiver decodes the message
b) The receiver sends feedback
c) The sender has an idea
d) The sender transmits the message through a channel and medium

2. During a video call, one speaker's internet keeps cutting out and a dog is barking behind another participant. In communication terms this is:

a) Noise
b) Poor encoding
c) A formal network
d) Feedback

3. A software company publishes a statement to customers and journalists about yesterday's service outage. This is:

a) Internal communication
b) Personal communication
c) External communication
d) Informal network communication

4. Rumours about a team restructuring spread through the canteen and WhatsApp before the official announcement. Which network carried them?

a) The formal network
b) External communication
c) Written communication
d) The informal network

5. The slides say 55% of communication is non-verbal, 38% tone and 7% words. What is the most accurate criticism of this statistic?

a) It only applies to written communication
b) It proves words do not matter in business
c) It came from experiments on feelings and attitudes when words and tone conflict, so it cannot be applied to all communication
d) It is accurate for every conversation, including technical explanations

6. A Dhaka team works with colleagues in Berlin and Toronto. One colleague keeps saying 'yes' in meetings but later does not deliver, because a direct 'no' feels rude in their culture. Which challenge is this?

a) Information overload
b) Cross-cultural and global communication
c) Adapting to technological change
d) Data privacy and security

7. After you explain a task, a junior developer nods and says 'okay' but delivers the wrong thing. What would most likely have caught the problem early?

a) Asking the receiver to restate the task in their own words (real feedback)
b) Sending the explanation in a longer email
c) Using a more formal tone
d) Moving the discussion to WhatsApp

8. A developer pastes a client's database password into a WhatsApp group with 40 members, including outside freelancers. Which challenge is most directly involved?

a) Generation gap in communication
b) Hybrid and remote work
c) Data privacy and security in communication
d) Emotional intelligence and empathy

9. What does 'decoding' mean in the communication process?

a) The sender chooses the words, tone and length
b) The receiver absorbs the message and interprets its meaning
c) The sender selects the channel
d) The receiver replies to the sender

10. Which of the following is an example of non-verbal communication?

a) A phone call
b) A written report
c) An email
d) Eye contact and posture

11. Which statement describes a formal communication network?

a) Planned and usually follows operational lines (for example manager to supervisor)
b) Complex and changes constantly
c) Spreads mainly through rumour
d) Has no fixed structure

12. An employee receives hundreds of emails, chat messages and notifications daily and misses an important deadline notice. This is an example of:

a) Generation gap
b) Information overload
c) Poor encoding by the sender only
d) Cross-cultural communication

True or False

Write True or False. If False, write one sentence to correct it.

1. Communication is a one-way process: the sender talks and the receiver listens. _____

2. Feedback is the final phase and shows whether the message was understood. _____

3. Noise means only loud sound in the environment. _____

4. Informal communication networks are fixed and never change. _____

5. If a message is technically correct, tone of voice and body language do not matter.
_____

6. The 55% / 38% / 7% statistic applies to all kinds of communication. _____

Short Answer

1. Explain the six phases of the communication process using a software example (for example a client explaining a requirement to a developer).

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2. Differentiate internal and external business communication. Give one software-company example of each and name the best channel for it.

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3. Choose any TWO of the ten workplace communication challenges in the chapter. For each, suggest one practical solution a software team can use.

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4. Compare the formal and informal communication networks in an organisation. How can a manager use the informal network wisely?

Activity Sheet: Message Sorting Game

No.	Message	Type	Oral / Written	Why?
1	Daily stand-up update to your team in a chat group			
2	Press statement about a service outage			
3	A proposal sent to a new client			
4	Birthday wish to a classmate on WhatsApp			
5	HR email announcing a new leave policy			
6	Reply to a customer complaint on the company Facebook page			
7	Message to a friend about weekend plans			
8	Sprint review presentation to your project manager			
9	Investor update email			
10	Job application email to a software company			
11	Bug report ticket assigned to a colleague			
12	Message to your family about when you will be home			
13	Notice to all staff about office closure on a holiday			
14	Product demo video shared with potential customers			
15	Venting to a friend about your day at work			
16	Support team reply giving a user steps to reset a password			